

Sumeyyah ([Arabic](#): سُمَيَّة; c. 550–615), was the [first member](#) of the [Ummah](#) (community) of the Islamic [prophet Muhammad](#) to become a [martyr](#) ([Arabic](#): شهيدة, [romanized](#): *shahīda*, [lit.](#) 'female martyr'). Shortly after she was martyred, her husband [Yasir ibn Amir](#) was also killed for his conversion to Islam, making him the first male martyr ([Arabic](#): شهيد, [romanized](#): *shahīd*).^{[1][2][3]} Her full name is said to be **Sumayya bint Khabbat** or **Sumayya bint Khayyat**. Her son was [Ammar ibn Yasir](#).

Early life

She was a slave of Abu Hudhayfa ibn al-Mughira, a member of the [Makhzum](#) clan in [Mecca](#).^[4] Her master gave her in marriage to [Yasir ibn Amir](#), who was from the Malik clan of the [Madh'hij](#) tribe in [Yemen](#). After coming to Mecca to look for a lost brother, he had decided to settle there under Abu Hudhayfa's protection.^{[1]:188[4]} Sumayyah gave birth to their son [Ammar](#) c.566.^{[1]:188[5][2][4]} Yasir also had two sons, Hurayth and Abdullah,^{[1]:189[4]}

At a later date, Abu Hudhayfa freed both Sumayyah and her son Ammar; but they remained his clients for the rest of his life.^{[1]:188[2][4][6]} It is said both that Abu Hudhayfa died "before Islam"^[4] and that he was "one of those who mocked the Prophet".^[4]

Conversion to Islam

According to one tradition, Sumayyah was one of the first seven "to display Islam", the other six being [Muhammad](#), [Abu Bakr](#), [Bilal](#), [Khabbab](#), [Suhayb](#) and her son Ammar.^{[1]:178} "To display Islam" might refer to something other than conversion since, according to another tradition, Ammar was not converted until after the [Muslims](#) had entered the house of [al-Arqam](#) "after thirty men".^{[1]:189} Yasir and his son Abdullah also converted "on the rise of Islam",^{[1]:188–189[2]:185[4][3][7]} but Hurayth had been killed by the Dil clan before 610.^{[1]:189[4]}

The [Quraysh](#) persecuted Muslims of low social rank.^{[8]:143[7]} Sumayyah's family was vulnerable after the death of their patron, and it was other members of the Makhzum clan who tortured them to pressure them to abandon their faith.^{[8]:145[2][3][9]} On one occasion she was put inside a pitcher full of water and lifted so that she could not escape. She, Yasir and Ammar were also forced to stand in the sun in the heat of the day dressed in [mail-coats](#).^{[8]:145[1]:178}

Although described as "a very old and frail woman", Sumayyah remained steadfast and refused to abandon Islam.^{[8]:145[2]}